

Climbing panda

The red panda uses its sharp claws to climb quickly through the trees. It feeds mainly on bamboo shoots, roots, grasses, and fruit. The panda often washes itself like a cat, licking a foot and then wiping the wet foot over its fur.

Red panda (*Ailurus fulgens*)
Body length: up to 2 ft 5 in (73 cm)
Tail: up to 19 in (49 cm)



The Huang He, or Yellow River, flows right across China. It contains a lot of silt, which gives the water a yellowish color.

KILOMETERS
0 150 300 450 600
MILES
0 100 200 300 400

PACIFIC OCEAN

JAPANESE MACAQUE

SEA OF JAPAN

JAPAN

JAPANESE GIANT SALAMANDER

Japanese giant salamander
(*Andrias japonicus*)
Length: up to 5 ft (1.5 m)



Giant from the past

The huge Japanese giant salamander is the second-largest living amphibian, after the Chinese salamander. Amphibians like this lived on Earth about 300 million years ago. The giant salamander lives in cold streams, using a flap of skin along the sides of its body to take in oxygen from the water. It also comes to the surface to take air into its lungs.



Mountainous forest covers about 70 percent of Japan's land area.

TAIWAN

Siberian tiger

(*Panthera tigris altaica*)
Body length: up to 9 ft 6 in (2.9 m)
Tail: up to 3 ft 7 in (109 cm)

Largest cat

The Siberian tiger is the largest and rarest big cat. It is larger, furrer, and paler than tigers in India and Indonesia. Tigers live alone, marking their territories with scent, droppings, and scrape marks. They also roar to tell other tigers to keep away. A tiger's roars can be heard up to 2 miles (3 km) away. There are probably only a few hundred Siberian tigers left in the wild.



Smelly stomach

The male musk deer has a gland under its stomach that produces a smelly substance called musk in the breeding season. Humans have killed many musk deer for this gland, which is used to make perfume. The male deer has canine teeth about 3 in (7 cm) long, which stick out of the sides of his mouth. In the breeding season, males fight each other with these teeth.



Forest musk deer
(*Moschus berezovskii*)
Body: up to 2 ft 8 in (80 cm)
Tail: up to 1.6 in (4 cm)

Chinese alligator
(*Alligator sinensis*)
Length: up to 7 ft 2 in (2.2 m)



Rare reptile

The timid Chinese alligator sleeps or hibernates in caves or burrows during the cold, dry winter months. It comes out in spring to mate and raise a family. This alligator feeds on snails, clams, rats, and insects. Today there are probably less than 200 of these alligators left due to the destruction of their habitat and collection by humans. They are found only in the lower part of the Chang Jiang river in eastern China.



The bamboo forests of Sichuan province in south-west China are home to the rare giant panda.

CHINA

CHINESE ALLIGATOR

EAST CHINA SEA

SOUTH CHINA SEA

HAINAN

NORTHERN TREESHREW

Xi Jiang

GOLDEN PHEASANT

BAIJI

Lake Dongting

Lake Poyang

Chang Jiang

Huang He

GIANT PANDA

RED PANDA

FOREST MUSK DEER